

TIMELINE

- **December 25, 1821** Born Clarissa Harlowe Barton, the youngest of five children, in Oxford, Massachusetts.
- **1832** Aged 11, she nurses her brother David for three years after he is injured in a farm accident.
- **1838** Starts a teaching job in Massachusetts.
- **1854** She establishes the first free school in New Jersey, at Bordentown, but is overlooked as principal in favor of a man.
- **1854** Moves to Washington, D. C., where she becomes the first woman to work as a clerk at the Patent Office.
- **July 1861** Leaves the Patent Office and sets up an agency to help wounded Union soldiers in Washington. Receives clothing and other donations from all over the country.
- **August 13, 1862** Arrives in Virginia a few days after the Battle of Cedar Mountain, having obtained permission to take medical supplies to the front.
- **September 17, 1862** Nurses the wounded on the battlefield of Antietam. Returns to Washington to recover from exhaustion and typhoid, but soon rejoins the Army of the Potomac on campaign.
- **April 1863** Travels to South Carolina. She is present at the siege of Fort Wagner in July.
- **Spring 1864** Tends the wounded at Fredericksburg, and works in a mobile field hospital with General Butler's Army of the James.
- **1865** Put in charge of finding missing Union soldiers by President Lincoln. Does valuable work identifying those who died at the notorious Confederate prison at Andersonville.
- **November 1866** Embarks on a lecture tour of the United States entitled, "Work and Incidents of Army Life," recounting her war experiences.
- **1869** Travels to Europe. While in Switzerland, she learns about the Geneva Convention and International Red Cross.
- **1870-71** In the Franco-Prussian War, Barton helps injured soldiers and organizes relief work.
- **1873** Returns to the United States in poor health.
- **1877** Travels to Washington to campaign for the United States to sign the Geneva Convention and recognize the International Red Cross.